

1 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

- 1.1 This procedure outlines the process used by ASI to develop the annual assessment plan for accredited/approved Conformity Assessment Bodies (CABs) in each accreditation/approval program.
- 1.2 This procedure applies for CABs accredited by ASI and for CABs which have transitioned their accreditation to the ASI Two-Tier Assurance Program (TTAP), ensuring an even sampling effort across both Tiers which seeks to avoid any negative impact upon the CAB's sampling rate.

2 CHANGE HISTORY

Version number	Date of approval (Effective date)	Description of changes
1.0	unknown	First publication
2.0	unknown	
3.0	31/01/2012	
4.0	25/10/2012	Inclusion of all current schemes
5.0	14/10/2013	Inclusion of RSB program and corrections in regard to the number of samples for witness assessments (FSC & RSPO)
5.1	08/10/2015	Changes of Technical Scopes and respective sampling rates; addition of GSTC scopes
5.2	29/03/2016	Removal of procedure section on compliance assessment and adaptation of information to match new ASI-PRO-20-111 (witness & compliance).
6.0	08/07/2016	Removal of internal requirements and update to reflect current practices. Removal of references to superseded Fee schedules.
6.1	15/08/2016	Addition of SBP scopes
6.2	05/12/2016	Review of table 2 and clarification of factors that affect sampling of Affiliate Offices
6.3	18/03/2018	Formatting changes; no content changes.
6.4	17 January 2019	Logo and name updated; no content changes.
6.5	15 October 2022	Minor revision in line with the ASI Two-Tier Assurance Program (i.e., addition of terms "Approval/approved", addition of clauses 1.2, 5.3.4, of item 17 in Table 2 and reference to Approval Procedure as applicable). Correction of numerical mistakes in Table 2. ASI Logo update.

3 TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

- 3.1 All terms and definitions are provided in the ASI Glossary (ASI-INF-20-100).

4 ASSOCIATED DOCUMENTATION

4.1	Procedures, Guidelines	ASI-PRO-20-101-Accreditation Procedure ASI-PRO-20-258-Approval Procedure ASI-PRO-20-111-Witness & Compliance Assessments ASI-INF-20-104-ASI Fee Schedule ASI-INF-20-100-ASI Glossary
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5 SAMPLING PROCEDURE

5.1 CAB Performance Review

5.1.1 At least once per calendar year, ASI shall review all assessment results and other relevant information (e.g. complaints, incidents, stakeholder input, business profile, etc.) for each CAB, since the date of the previous review.

5.1.2 ASI shall modify and adjust the annual sampling plan based on the results of the CAB Performance Review.

5.1.3 The executive summary of the CAB Performance Review shall be made available to each respective CAB.

5.2 Assessment Plan

5.2.1 Following the CAB Performance Review, ASI shall prepare an assessment plan for the forthcoming year for each CAB, following the sampling design described in this procedure.

Note: ASI may prepare an assessment plan for a period longer than one year to facilitate better oversight of CAB competence.

5.2.2 CABs shall be informed about the ASI Assessment Plan no less than two months prior to the first scheduled assessment.

5.2.2.1 The plan shall include assessment sample numbers per each accredited/approved program.

5.2.2.2 The annual Assessment Schedule (ASI-INF-20-108) shall be made publicly available on the ASI website.

5.2.3 Sample numbers are the total number of samples required per CAB. The sample numbers may be further adjusted a) to account for any identified risk factors relevant to the scope and operation of a CAB and b) in consideration of the size of a CAB's program.

5.3 Basal Sampling Rate

5.3.1 ASI shall use a basal sampling rate (BSR) as a default assumption in setting the number of annual assessments of each accredited/approved CAB in the Program.

5.3.2 The BSR specifies for each accredited/approved CAB:

5.3.2.1 One office assessment of the head office of the CAB; and

5.3.2.2 One representative witness assessment of a conformity assessment activity conducted by the CAB within each of the CAB's scopes of accreditation/approval; and

5.3.2.3 A representative number of witness and affiliate office assessments as determined by the formula in Table 1.

5.3.3 Witness assessments may be substituted by compliance assessments or desk reviews at the sole discretion of ASI.

5.3.4 For CABs which have entered the Two-Tier Assurance Program, ASI will take into account the sampling conducted by Participating Accreditation Bodies (ABs) as part of Tier one and accrue this sampling against the BSR.

5.4 Sample Number

5.4.1 The calculations to derive the required number of witness or compliance assessment samples required per scope per CAB are provided in Table 1.

Table 1. Formula for deriving numbers of witness assessments for each program

Program	Assessment Type	Number of Samples
All	Office	$BSR + (0.20 * \text{no. of affiliate offices})$
ASC	Aquaculture	$BSR + (0.05 * \text{no. of certified/under assessment farms})$
	Feed	$BSR + (0.05 * \text{no. of certified/under assessment feed mills})$
FSC	CoC	$BSR + (0.005 * \text{no. of certificates})$
	Forest Management	$BSR + (0.03 * \text{no. of certificates})$
GSTC	C-HTO	See latest version of GSTC Accreditation Manual
	C-D	See latest version of GSTC Accreditation Manual
MSC	CoC	$BSR + (0.01 * \text{no. of certificates})$
	Fisheries	$BSR + (0.05 * \text{no. of certified/under assessment fisheries})$
RSB	Primary Biomass Production	$BSR + (0.03 * \text{no. of certificates})$
	Biomass Processing	$BSR + (0.03 * \text{no. of certificates})$
RSPO	P&Cs	$BSR + (0.03 * \text{no. of certificates})$
	Supply Chain	$BSR + (0.005 * \text{no. of certificates})$
Notes	All: Round results to nearest whole number.	

5.5 Affiliate Office Assessments

5.5.1 In addition to the annual assessment of the accredited/approved head office, as a general rule ASI shall perform at least one assessment of each CAB affiliate office (see ASI glossary definition) during the five-year accreditation/approval cycle (i.e. 20% of CAB affiliate offices are sampled annually).

5.5.2 CABs shall notify ASI about any changes regarding affiliate offices, including addition or removal thereof. CABs shall notify ASI within 30 days of such changes, unless a different timeframe is set by the relevant ASI program manager - which takes precedence over the 30 days established in this procedure.

- 5.5.3 In the case of an additional affiliate office, ASI shall review the risk associated with the new entity to determine the need for and level of additional surveillance activities. The conclusions from this review shall be noted by ASI in its records of assessment planning.
- 5.5.4 Individual CAB affiliate offices may be subject to increased or decreased sampling frequency according to a risk analysis (Table 2). This can result in deviations from the rule stipulated in 5.5.1 above, and will be recorded and justified by ASI in its records of assessment planning. These justifications are available to CABs upon request.

Table 2. Selection criteria for increased surveillance of a CAB Affiliate Office (AO)

No.	Factors for increasing or decreasing sampling rate of AO, and for selecting AO
1	is subject to a complaint or other form of dispute.
2	is involved in or subject to an official investigation of any kind.
3	operates in a country or region that ASI has identified as representing a significant risk.
4	has had more than two major non-conformities raised by ASI during the previous office assessment.
5	manages more than 50 certificates.
6	has a recent history of poorly managed audit teams.
7	is the subject of significant and justified concerns from both ASI and the respective Scheme Owner.
8	Type of AO (branch/ subsidiary/ subcontractor)
9	Technical scope(s) of AO (number and complexity)
10	Proportion and type of key certification activities that occur in the AO
11	Countries where AO operates and associated portfolio risk
12	Number of certificates, and proportion of the CAB's certificates this represents
13	Results of the CAB annual performance appraisal (including control of NCs and audit scheduling, and risk register results)
14	Consistency of performance among AO, as shown by results of ASI assessments
15	Complaints and other disputes related to AO management
16	Concerns from ASI and/or the scheme owner
17	any performance information derived from Tier one for TTAP CABs.

5.6 Sample selection

- 5.6.1 The selection of CAB certificates for ASI assessment is at the sole discretion of ASI.
- 5.6.2 In selecting samples for witness and compliance assessments, ASI shall consider the risk factors and selection criteria listed in Table 3 below, as well as the Procedure for Witness and Compliance Assessments (ASI-PRO-20-111).
- 5.6.3 Depending on the scheme's specific requirements, additional criteria for selecting assessment samples may apply.

Approved by: ASI Managing Director

Date of approval: 15 October 2022

Table 3. Criteria for Selecting Samples for Witness and Compliance Assessments.

No.	Risk Factor / Selection Criterion
	Criteria related to certificate issued by CAB: The certificate
1	is the subject of significant and justified concerns from both ASI and the respective Scheme Owner.
2	is subject to a complaint or other form of dispute that is supported by documentary evidence.
3	was issued in a country or region that ASI has identified as representing a significant risk area.
4	was identified for further follow-up during an ASI office assessment or desk review.
5	was issued in a country or region in which the CAB does not normally operate (non-native country) or in which the CAB has only recently started.
6	is for a product or service that was not offered by a CAB in previous years in a country or region.
7	represents an opportunity to sample from a CAB lead auditor that has not been witnessed previously by ASI.
8	represents an opportunity to sample the work of a CAB's affiliate that has not been witnessed previously by ASI.
9	allows a reasonable opportunity based on logistical considerations, including combination of trips and availability of ASI assessors and experts.
10	is selected at random.

5.7 Assessment duration

- 5.7.1 Assessment duration includes the number of days spent on-site, plus time spent preparing for the assessment, reviewing CAB documentation and preparing ASI reports.
- 5.7.2 Assessment duration is measured in assessor-days.
- 5.7.3 The estimated assessment duration of initial accreditation/approval is presented in the ASI Fee Schedule (ASI-INF-20-124).
- 5.7.4 Before each assessment, ASI shall provide a budget with the estimated assessment duration to the CAB. The duration estimate is for guidance only and may be subject to change. ^[1]_[SEP]

6 ASSESSMENT PLAN IMPLEMENTATION

- 6.1 ASI shall implement its annual assessment plan through the use of four primary assessment activities: office assessments, witness assessments, compliance assessments and desk reviews.
- 6.2 Each planned assessment may be substituted by another type of assessment or desk review as deemed necessary, at the sole discretion of ASI.
- 6.3 ASI shall confirm assessment dates with the CAB.

- 6.4 In the case that the confirmation of the assessment date is not possible or is delayed due to lack of cooperation from the CAB, ASI has the sole discretion to adjust or change its assessment activity or to implement other disciplinary measures, as described in the ASI Accreditation Procedure (ASI-PRO-20-101) or the ASI Approval Procedure (ASI-PRO-20-258) as applicable.
- 6.5 ASI shall announce its assessment dates to interested parties using appropriate channels.
- 6.6 ASI assessments may be carried out on short notice as required by ASI at its own discretion.
- 6.6.1 The CAB shall be informed of a short notice assessment no more than two weeks prior to the assessment taking place.
- 6.6.2 Stakeholder consultation is not required prior to a short notice assessment, but stakeholders may be consulted either during or after an ASI short notice assessment.
- 6.7 ASI may use remote means (e.g. teleconference or other forms of electronic media) for performing its assessments.

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